

AGENTS, HONESTLY

**MY BEST
AGENT
PUBLISHED
NOTHING
THAT DAY.**

SWIPE →

WHAT WAS MEANT TO HAPPEN

On **23** August one of my agents was due to build and queue a post about that week's AI news. It queued nothing at all.

MY FIRST THOUGHT

That it had broken. Something in the chain had failed quietly, and I would spend the evening finding out where.

WHAT IT HAD ACTUALLY DONE

Checked its own rule. I had told it never to use a story more than two days old. It looked, found nothing that fresh, and stopped.

THE WEEKEND PROBLEM

Software companies do not announce things at the weekend. A Sunday run building for a Monday slot has almost nothing it is allowed to use.

WHAT IT REFUSED TO DO

Stretch the rule by a day to fill the slot. It is not allowed to change its own instructions, so it wrote down why it had stopped and handed the problem back.

SO I LET IT STAND

An agent that fills a slow day with something weak costs more than one that leaves the slot empty. You can see an empty slot.

WHAT SHIPPED THAT SAME WEEK

Anthropic's releases were mostly about control. You can now limit which sites an agent may visit, and see what each of its tool calls cost.

THE STOP WAS THE FEATURE.

Let's count what we skip.